

amazing indoor and outdoor environments, in vehicles, and on foot with the largest arsenal of futuristic weapons, vehicles, and combat roles of any shooter ever.

Genre: FPS/Action

Developer: Bungie

Estimated release date: Mid-2002

MEDAL OF HONOR: ALLIED ASSAULT

World War II games seem to be the latest fad in shooters, but no other game stands taller in the quest for best FPS of 2002 than *Medal of Honor: Allied Assault*. The game goes beyond the run-and-gun theme with an assortment of missions to carry out. The environment is totally immersive and facets of war are highlighted beautifully. There are soldiers everywhere—shouting, giving orders, running for their lives, and fighting. So while you go on sniper hunts, driving tanks and setting up beach heads just like Private Ryan once did, you'll be happy to know that this is just the tip of the iceberg—the fun lies inside.

Genre: Tactical Action

Developer: Electronic Arts

Release date: January 2002



3D API and incorporates higher polygon counts and greater detail.

In the elaborate single-player missions, you find yourself caught in the middle of a full-scale interstellar war in a fictional universe. You have to fight your way through to discover the source of conflict and bring peace to the universe.

In addition to the gripping single-player missions, gamers expect *Unreal II* to include the gripping multiplayer component that made *Unreal Tournament* a smash hit.

Genre: FPS/Action

Developer: Epic Games

Estimated release date: March 2002

WARCRAFT III

In a poll at Voodooextreme.com, Blizzard ranked as the most respected game development outfit among gamers. For anyone who's been impressed by Blizzard's line up of games, there's bound to be profound anticipation when *WarCraft III* comes out. Remember, these guys made *Diablo*.

It's humans versus creatures, magic mixed with metal, in the third installment of the *WarCraft* franchise. The success behind this series is a perfect blend of real-time strategy with



SOLDIER OF FORTUNE II: DOUBLE HELIX

Double Helix is the sequel to the grossly violent FPS hit of the year 2000. You play the part of John Mullins and embark on an intercontinental mission to fight against an organisation of bio-terrorists who plan to unleash a deadly virus on the world's populace.

This anti-terrorist thriller uses the *Quake III: Team Arena* engine. It will offer wannabe warriors with an expanded arsenal and perhaps even a beefed up multiplayer experience. A random scenario generator which lets players create random single-player missions and superior enemy AI will make playing *Soldier of Fortune II* an even greater challenge when it hits the shelves sometime in April 2002.

Genre: FPS/Action

Developer: Raven

Estimated release date: April 2002

UNREAL II

One of the most anticipated titles of this year comes from Epic Games and is the latest reincarnation of the *Unreal* series which is expected in March 2002. The *Unreal II* graphics engine is based on the Direct



role-playing elements for plenty of zest. In *Warcraft III*, the game has departed from its 2D platform and entered a full-fledged 3D environment overflowing with smooth and crisp animation.

Generating characters that garner new abilities along with experience and know-how to use them is the key strategy in *WarCraft III*.

Genre: Real-time Strategy

Developer: Blizzard

Estimated release date: March 2002

This year's harvest is by far the most bountiful as far as the gaming world is concerned. From action to strategy, role-playing to racing—each genre of gaming has evolved many steps further. Not only are the graphics visibly superior than in the earlier games, but the developers have also remembered well the value that gameplay really holds, not to mention the fact that God really does lie in the details.

Also, with the release of next-generation graphics cards from nVidia and ATi, the time couldn't be better for lower-end cards such as the GeForce3 to shed prices for those lean on budgets.

So all of you who had to sit back and wait for a reason to upgrade the GPU, it's time for action! Dust that PC and fire up the graphics card—the gaming drought is over. ☞